MIA XR COLLECTIVE PITCH · ROME · 22 OCTOBER 2026

Engine Mastery × Craft

Why the studios winning in immersive need both

Alex Coulombe
CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design



YOUR SPEAKER

Alex Coulombe

Founder & CEO, Agile Lens: Immersive Design

Architect turned XR-chitect who has spent the last decade building spatial experiences for the world's most ambitious clients.

Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020: 300+ classes taught, 40+ courses written.

16	10	10	100+
YEARS IN XR	YEARS OF AGILE LENS	YEARS IN UNREAL	EXPERIENCES BUILT

ROYAL SHAKESPEARE COMPANY

CBS

FOUR SEASONS

ARLEKIN PLAYERS

WALDORF ASTORIA

AGILE LENS

IMMERSIVE DESIGN STUDIO

EST. 2016

NYC

LINCOLN CENTER

KENNEDY CENTER

FISHER DACHS ASSOCIATES

ACTORS THEATRE OF LOUISVILLE

SAMSUNG

DELL

ROYAL CARIBBEAN

BOOTSTRAPPED · XR SPECIALISTS · 10 YEARS

ACT I · 1 / 4

Beautiful Demos Are Easy. Shipping Them Isn't.

Immersive work lives or dies in the gap between the trailer and the headset

Engine mastery: it runs, beautifully, on the hardware audiences actually have

Craft: once they're inside, they care

ENGINE MASTERY · CRAFT

We teach the engine we build in

300+ classes taught.
40+ courses written.

Authorized Unreal Engine instructor since 2020



A Christmas Carol VR 2025 trailer · Agile Lens

ACT I · TWO HALVES

Photoreal That Actually Runs

Heavy scenes, real hardware

- We optimized photoreal digital humans to run on standalone headsets
- That moved *A Christmas Carol VR* from gaming PCs to headsets audiences already own
- Increasing access is worth the work, as long as the artistic vision survives

Royal Caribbean · Perfect Day Mexico

Nearly 1,000 guests. Four days at sea.

A hot-air-balloon ride over Perfect Day Mexico, aboard Utopia of the Seas, September 2025 · Standalone headsets, offline, about 10 minutes a ride, run by the client's volunteers from our operations manual

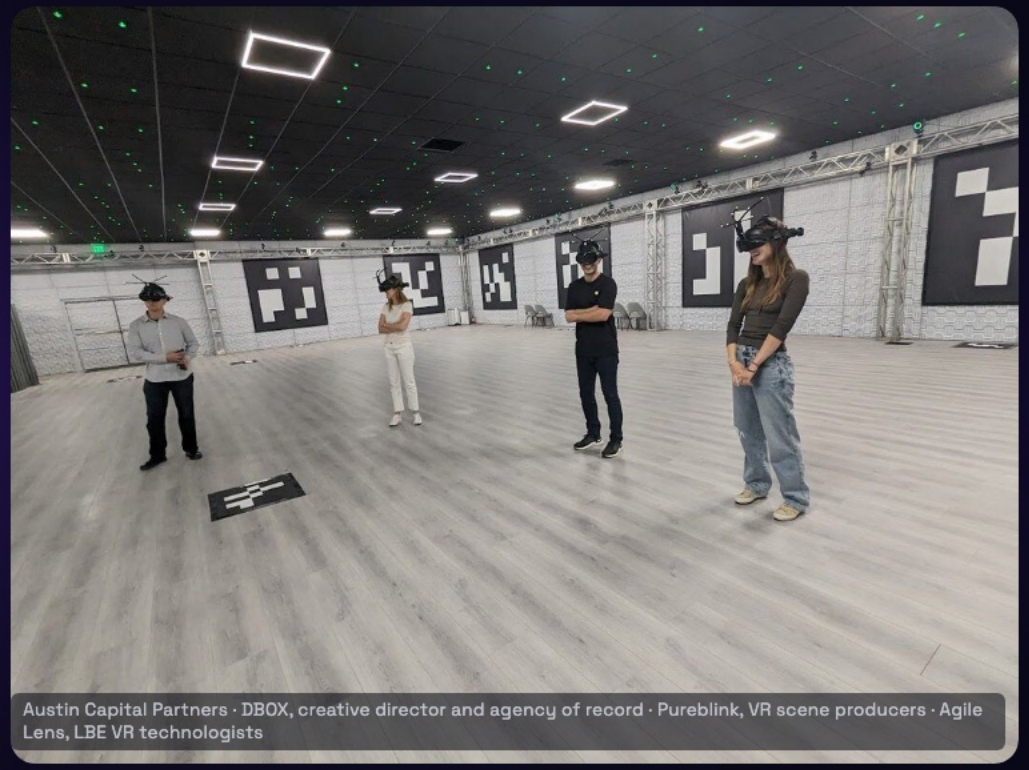
PICO Space Pro

First company in the US with access to PICO Space Pro.

ACT II · 2 / 4

Fidelity That Converts.

Luxury brands don’t buy demos. They buy belief.



Austin Capital Partners · DBOX, creative director and agency of record · Pureblink, VR scene producers · Agile Lens, LBE VR technologists

ACT II · FIDELITY

Four Seasons Private Residences

Lake Austin: luxury homes, toured from a headset

- Buyers walk full-scale, photoreal residences years before they're built
- A wireless, walkable holodeck of about 5,000 square feet: families tour together, no cables
- We engineered the location-based VR, set it up, and ran its first six months of operation

The Part Nobody Sees



Holodeck build for Four Seasons Private Residences, Lake Austin · Agile Lens, LBE VR technologists


Four Seasons tours at DBOX, New York
Headset on in New York.
Standing in Austin.

eVTOL air-taxi passenger simulation

Take the flight before it exists.

A passenger-flight simulation for an eVTOL air-taxi company: a ride over New York

ACT III · 3 / 4

Craft Is the Other Half.

Engine mastery gets the scene running. Craft decides whether anyone cares.



ACT III · CRAFT

A Christmas Carol VR

Live actors. Live audiences. One shared virtual stage.

- Live actors with face and full-body capture perform on the streets of a virtual Victorian London
- Fully remote: actors, crew and audience each join from wherever they are
- Five holiday seasons, 2021–2025 · The final run, December 2025: 15 performances



A Christmas Carol VR · Agile Lens · performed live by Ari Tarr and Debbie Deer · adapted by Robert Barry Fleming

In Their Words

Raindance Immersive 2025 nominee, Best Immersive Theatre · Audience comments as published on xmascarolvr.com, 2021–2025

"WOW doesn't even come close to describing what I just experienced! I haven't enjoyed 'A Christmas Carol' this much in years."

Robert Copelan, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Each year, Agile Lens is like pushing the edge for what's next."

Kent Bye
Voices of VR podcast · 2025

"A Christmas Carol VR is a masterclass in acting"

Raindance Immersive 2025 judges
as quoted on xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"We're extremely curious to see what Agile Lens and their creators do next with theatre in VR"

Ian Hamilton
UploadVR, editorial · 2025

"I sat on that bench and looked up at Scrooge... and [he] emotionally spoke, of me... It felt remarkable!"

Chuck Webster, MD, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"This was a working glimpse into the future of VR as a medium for Real Time Live Production."

Jimmy6DOF, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2021

"It was fascinating to see the affordances of VR used in this way. I'd love to see more VR plays done like this."

Claren Naïlo, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2024

"Agile Lens represents a model of artistry that transcends mediums and time zones alike."

Siobhan Greene, Instinctively Real Media
the show's media sponsor · 2025

"The evolution of this show over the years is remarkable and the performances are top shelf!"

Stephen Butchko, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2025

"Quite enjoyed catching the opening night of this. The world needs more live VR performances!"

Nick Suda, audience
xmascarolvr.com · 2025



XR Network+ RSC Challenge 2025 film · Agile Lens

ACT III · CRAFT

Royal Shakespeare Company

Virtual rehearsal tools, developed with the RSC

- Actors rehearse in a 1:1 scan of the Swan Theatre; directors follow along from a laptop
- Built with theater people, for theater people: the script stays in your hand, like paper
- An R&D grant with XR Network+, 2024–2025: tested with drama students, shown in Stratford

Same Rehearsal, Two Rooms

Drag the line



XR Inside a Normal Film Pipeline

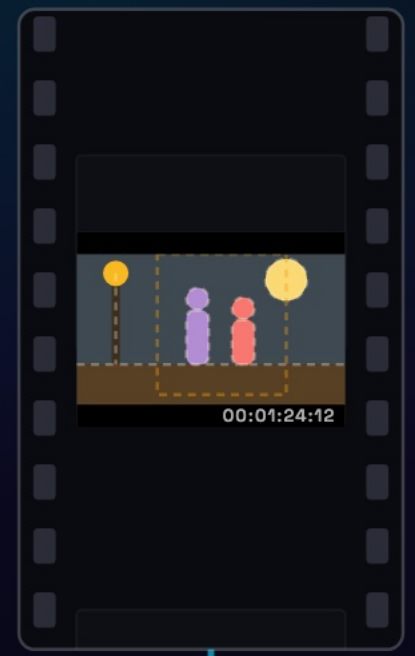
The crew uses the headset. The audience gets a normal film.



XR for the crew

PRE-PRODUCTION	PRODUCTION	POST-PRODUCTION
● Scout a scanned location in VR	● Rehearse actors in the virtual set	● Shoot new coverage from recordings
● Try lenses, lights and blocking at 1:1	● Capture performance onto digital humans	● Reframe with a virtual camera
● Pull stills into the shot list	○ Real-time previs and virtual sets	● Review in VR, like dailies

● Agile Lens has built this ○ What XR can do



A normal film. Any screen.



Scan the Real Place. Walk It Before You Fly.

Gaussian splats: a photoreal capture of a real location you can stand in

- Capture a real place in minutes, with a phone or a scanner
- Photoreal, view-dependent detail at human scale
- Walk it in VR at 1:1: scout, block, try lenses, plan shots
- Share the space with a remote director, DP or producer
- Reuse it as a virtual-production backdrop or set extension
- Lighter than a photoreal mesh; cheap to re-scan when the place changes

● Agile Lens has done this ○ What a splat can do



What a Splat Can’t Do (Yet)

Worth knowing before you plan a shoot around one

It’s a frozen moment
No moving people, no running water: it records one instant

The light is baked in
Relighting is limited; you get the light you scanned

Rights come first
Scanning places and people needs permission

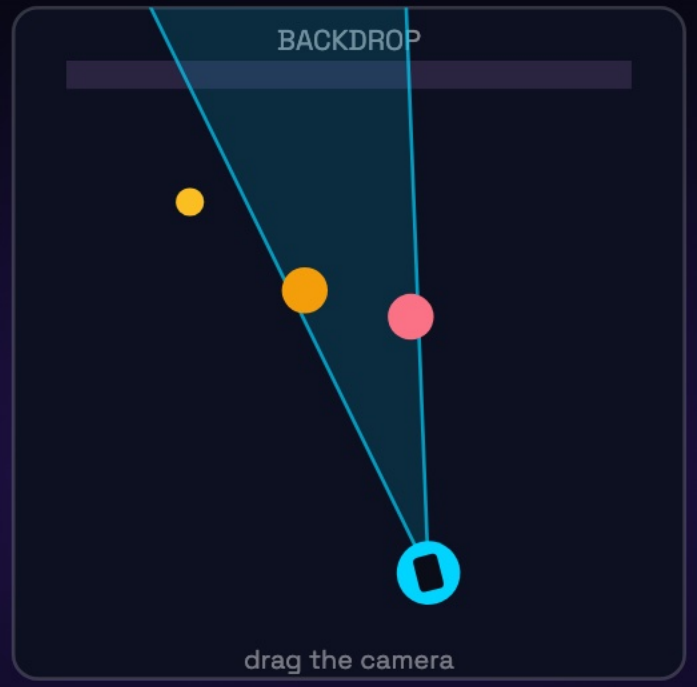
Big files
Standalone headsets need trimmed scans

Young editing tools
Cleanup and editing are still catching up

Find the Shot Before You Fly

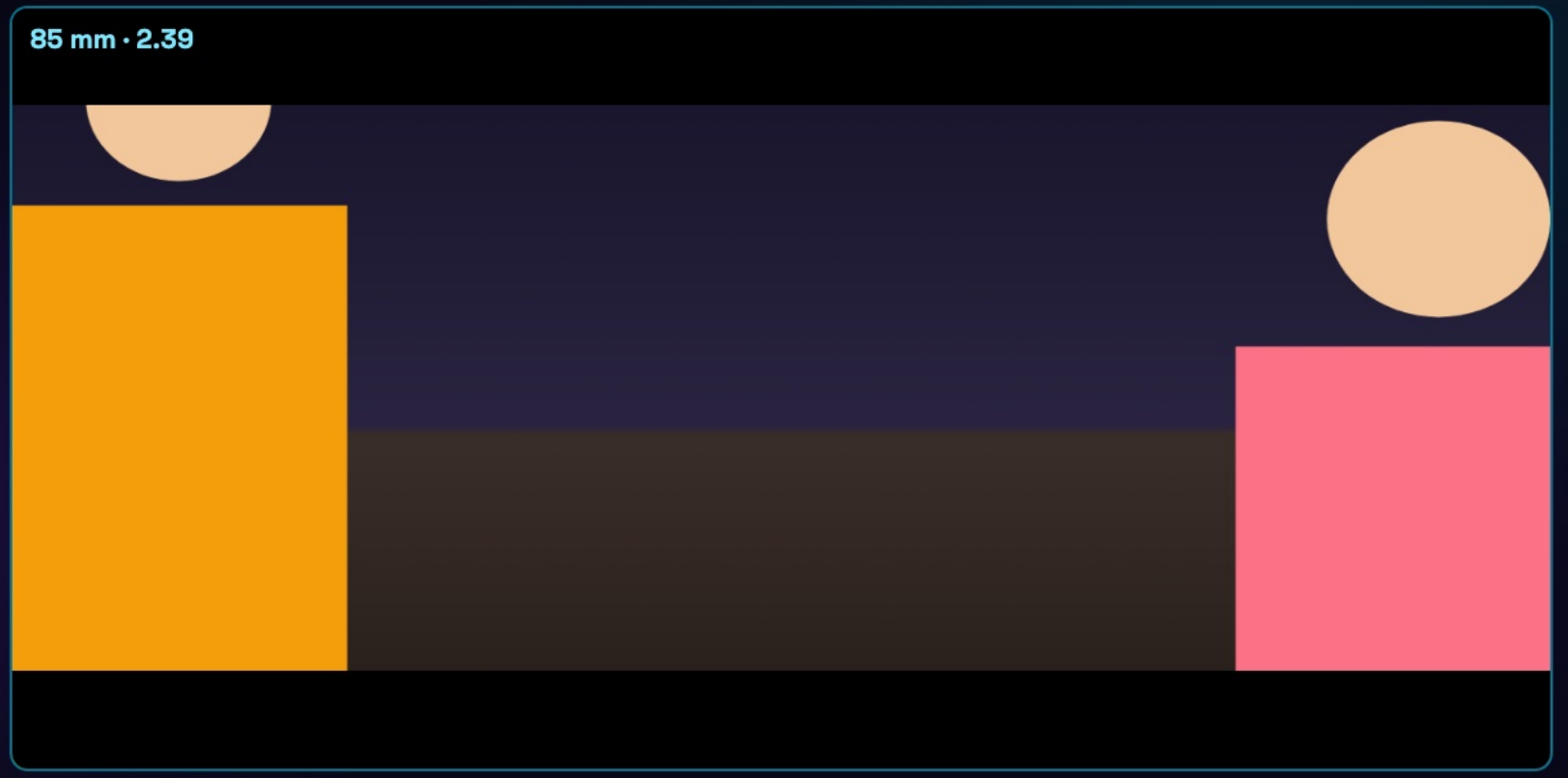
Drag the camera. Pick a lens. Take the shot.

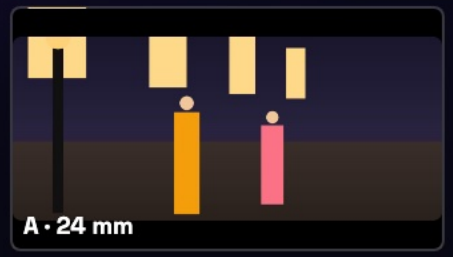
CONCEPT DEMO, BUILT FOR THIS TALK

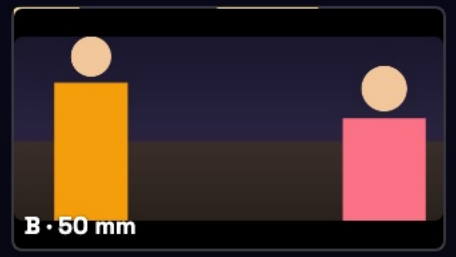


24 mm | 35 mm | 50 mm | 85 mm

2.39 mask | Take shot









Cut Your Own Version of the Show

At our table today: a prototype built overnight for MIA



THE RECORDING

The full show, recorded

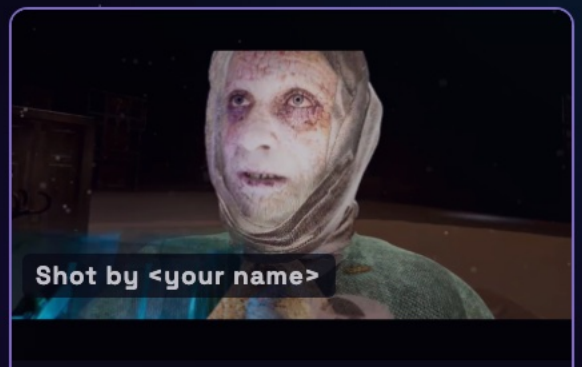
Laptop and gamepad, offline. Default scene: Dickens and Scrooge



YOU

You are the camera operator

Fly a virtual camera through the performance; 24, 35, 50 or 85 mm



YOUR SHOT

Your shot, credited

Add or replace a shot anywhere in the show



A NEW CUT

A new cut of the whole show

Plays back in 2.39 with a WORKING CUT title card; survives a crash; exports

Recorded show — Your camera — Credited — Working cut

ACT IV · 4 / 4

What Kind of Partnerships Are We Looking For?

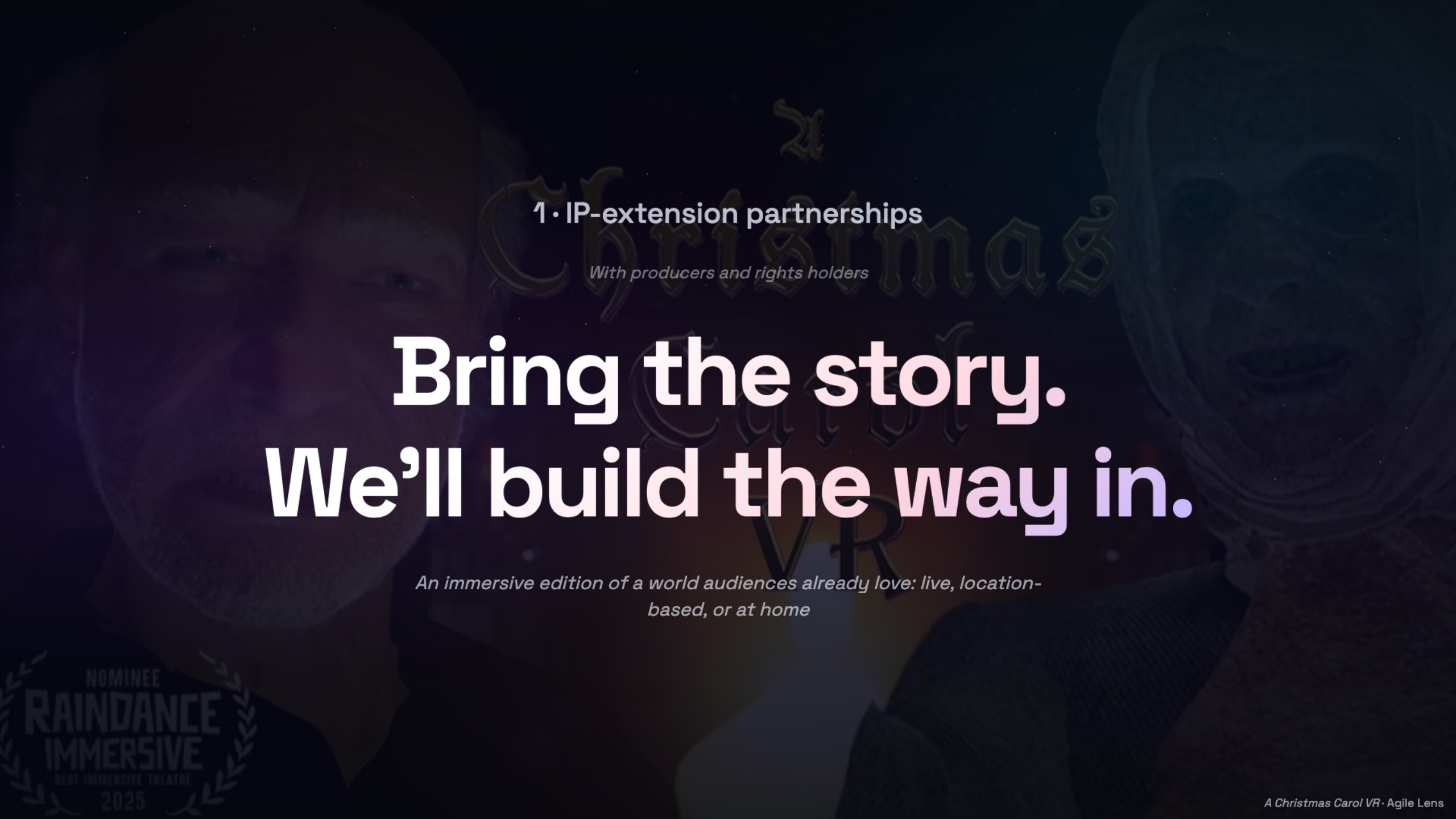
Two kinds. Both start with a story you already own or produce.

1 · IP-extension partnerships

With producers and rights holders

Bring the story. We'll build the way in.

An immersive edition of a world audiences already love: live, location-based, or at home





2 · Co-productions from day one

Immersive inside the financing and distribution plan

In the plan, not bolted on after.

Budgeted with the production: new windows, new audiences, assets that carry across formats

RSC rehearsal R&D · Agile Lens

How we start

One story.
One audience.
One prototype.

A short, paid prototype of a single audience moment, then a production plan you can finance


Craft makes them care.
Engineering makes sure they can.

GRAZIE

Let’s Build the Way In.

IP-extension partnerships · Co-productions with immersive in the plan from day one

WEB agilelens.com

FIND US Demo area, Sala Trianon

Agile Lens

Say hello

Agile Lens